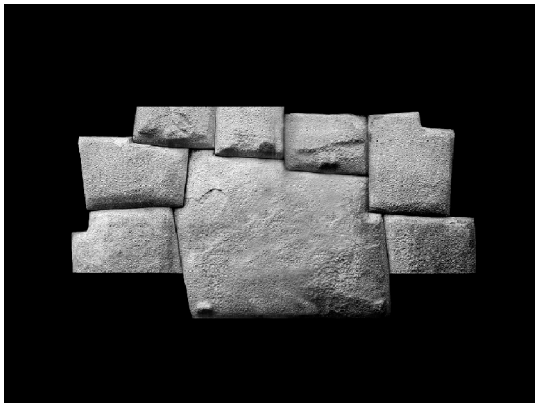
Artist Talk: An experience of sinergy on Latinamerican indigenous instruments and electronic live media: the Orchestra of authoctonous instruments and new technologies of the National University of Tres de Febrero, Argentina



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Abstract

Composers in the so called peripheral countries are at the crossroads between finding their own personal identity as creators and their cultural identity as members of a community that encompasses them. The challenge relates to getting to be oneself, discovering one's "uniqueness" in all its potency.

This process not only affects the creator but also influences and transforms the very geoculture he was born into.

The transculturization of elements (as in the case of avant-garde techniques and composing in the classical style of european origin) must be digested, internalized, in order to reappear with a special potency, a unique color that will broaden the fringes of knowledge, as one explores the unknown lands of creation.

This challenge is not only individual and "cultural" but also instrumental and operative, that is to say, it entails the election of the technique and fundamentally the means (the tools) the creator will choose, free from any "a priori", any prejudice that may restrain his visionary capacity.

A number of different subjects must be approached:
a) the antagonism between encyclopedic learning and one of wisdom;
b) not assuming the space one inhabits;
c) admiration for paradigms that are foreign to us, and that can only lead to insatisfaction.
d) a new regard to native instruments, giving them the same "onthological dignity" than european instruments have.

The act of committing oneself to the demands of finding a way to "be and do" that is well-rooted in the time and culture we belong to, erases the supposed dichotomy between contemporary creative techniques and cultural roots.

Finding that path, accepting the challenge, opens us to an unsuspected area of freedom. Composers must travel along this path, this process ripening not only in a personal way but also as members of a community, although in fact, both are the same.

Founded in 2004, the ***Orchestra*** is based on the experience of the Ensemble ***Fronteras del Silencio (The Borders of Silence).*** Created in 2001 by a group of composers-interpreters (Luciano Borrillo, Mariano Fernandez, Daniel Judkovski, Federico Martinez, Julieta Szewach, Daniel Vacs) under the direction of Alejandro Iglesias Rossi; the instrumentation of the Ensemble is an unusual one: 100 chrystal glasses, indigenous Southamerican instruments, prepared piano, percussion, violin, electric guitar and electronic media.

The Ensemble has performed widely in Latinamerica. Its recordings have been broadcasted by Radios around the world (Radio France, BBC Radio, Deutschland Radio-Berlin, RAI 3, Polish National Radio, Australian Broadcasting Corporation, NHK-Tokio, Societe Radio Canada-CBC, Danmarks National Radio, etc).

"Every performance of Fronteras del Silencio has an almost ritual character, with primigenial sonorities contrasted with electronic processes and a non-traditional instrumentation."
Radio Beethoven, Santiago de Chile on its XXth Century Program. (Comment on the Ensemble's performance at the XII Chilean Contemporary Music Festival, december 2002)

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